AxarquíaHome



2026-2027 EDITION

Checklist: moving to or wintering in the Axarquía

Paperwork, tax, healthcare, money, car and pets, and the house itself: everything in order for anyone staying longer in Spain.

The coast at Nerja

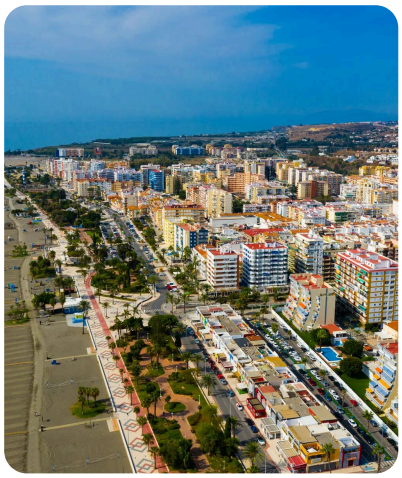
Welcome to the Axarquía

White villages against the mountains, terraces full of olive, almond and avocado trees, and a coastline of little coves beneath the cliffs. The Axarquía, east of Málaga, is one of the most beautiful places in Andalusia to live.

With around 300 days of sunshine a year, Málaga airport about an hour's drive away and villages such as Frigiliana, Cómpeta and Nerja, it is easy to see why so many Dutch, German, Swedish and British people have a home here. A house in this region does need the right approach, and that is what this checklist helps with.



Frigiliana



Torre del Mar



Canillas de Albaida

> Anyone who wants to spend more than a holiday in the Axarquía deals with two countries: what to wrap up at home and what to arrange in Spain. It is not difficult, but there is a lot of it, and the order matters.
>
> This checklist sets out the steps for moving and for spending the winter. Tick off what you have arranged and take it to your appointments.



Cómpeta and the Sierra Almijara

1. Moving or wintering?

The 183-day line decides a lot: tax, healthcare and your registration.

- [ ] Worked out how many days a year you will be in Spain, and where your family and income are
- [ ] Found out in which country you will be tax resident
- [ ] Checked what happens to your state pension, pension or benefits if you move
- [ ] If wintering: kept your registration at home and made that a conscious choice
- [ ] If moving: planned the date of deregistration and the move
- [ ] Considered a trial period: rent for a winter before you buy



Frigiliana

2. Paperwork in Spain

- [ ] NIE number applied for (needed for almost everything)
- [ ] For stays over three months: registered as a resident (EU certificado de registro, or a visa/TIE if you are from outside the EU)
- [ ] Registered on the town hall register (empadronamiento)
- [ ] Spanish bank account opened
- [ ] Digital certificate or Cl@ve set up for online dealings with the government
- [ ] Copies of passport, NIE and key papers kept digitally



Bougainvillea in Nerja

3. Healthcare and insurance

- [ ] If wintering: valid EHIC/GHIC and travel insurance for the whole period
- [ ] If moving: arranged how you join the Spanish health system (S1 form with a pension, or private insurance)
- [ ] Found your nearest health centre (centro de salud)
- [ ] Medicines and prescriptions for the whole period, with Spanish names added
- [ ] Home and contents insurance adjusted to a longer stay
- [ ] Car insurance, if you bring your own car



The village square of Canillas de Albaida

4. Tax and money

The Spanish tax office (Hacienda) also expects a return from non-residents.

- [ ] Spanish tax calendar noted: IBI, rubbish tax and the returns
- [ ] As a non-resident: annual return for your Spanish home (modelo 210)
- [ ] As a resident: income tax return (IRPF) and possibly modelo 720 for assets abroad
- [ ] Checked whether a tax treaty applies to your pension
- [ ] Regular bills on direct debit from your Spanish account
- [ ] Chosen a tax adviser (gestor or asesor fiscal) who speaks English



Torre del Mar

5. Car, pets and belongings

- [ ] If moving: car on Spanish plates within the deadline, or buy a car in Spain
- [ ] Driving licence exchanged in time if you become resident
- [ ] Pet: chip, passport and rabies vaccination arranged in time
- [ ] Removal company or transport chosen, with an inventory
- [ ] Post forwarded or received digitally
- [ ] Subscriptions at home cancelled or adjusted

The house ready for longer stays

A holiday home is not the same as a house you live in all winter. Heating, insulation, a place to work and damp deserve attention before you arrive.



Mineral wool insulation being laid between timber joists by hands in work gloves



Condensation on the glass and mould in the corner beside a window, with a cloth on the sill to catch the water

6. The house itself

- [ ] Heating and cooling suitable for winter and summer
- [ ] Insulation of roof, windows and doors checked
- [ ] Damp and mould dealt with before you live there longer
- [ ] Fast internet arranged (fibre, 4G/5G or satellite)
- [ ] Bathroom and stairs suitable for later in life
- [ ] Key holding arranged for the months you are away



Frigiliana

7. Questions to ask

Your tax adviser

1. In which country will I be tax resident, and from when?
2. How will my pension be taxed?
3. Which returns must I file, and when?
4. Do I need to file modelo 720?
5. What happens to my assets and any inheritance?
6. What does it cost to have you handle this each year?
7. Can you also arrange the NIE and registration?
8. In which language can we communicate?

Your town hall and health insurer

1. Which papers do I need for the empadronamiento?
2. How do I book an appointment, and how long does it take?
3. Am I covered for the whole period as a winter visitor?
4. Which care does the EHIC/GHIC cover, and which not?
5. How do I join Spanish healthcare with an S1 form?
6. Can I choose a GP at the centro de salud?
7. What about the medicines I use now?
8. What must I do if I move back?



Getting the house ready for longer stays?

We help with the work the house needs before you live there longer, and look after it while you are away. Our team works with a trusted building partner in the Axarquía.

Ask us

axarquiahome.com/en/request/ · info@axarquiahome.com

This checklist gives general information and is not tax or legal advice. Rules change and depend on your situation; always ask an adviser.